Project Report: School Visit & Mentorship Program

Field	Details
Reference	ADA/2022/004
Project Title	School Visit & Mentorship
Period	May 1–31, 2022
Location	Buea, South-West Region, Cameroon
Beneficiaries Reached	25 secondary school students
Budget Spent	165,000 CFA ($275 USD) of 180,000 CFA ($300 USD)

1. Executive Summary

ADA conducted its first in-school mentorship visit in May 2022, engaging 25 secondary school students (ages 10–14, predominantly boys in blue uniforms) in Buea. The project marked a strategic shift from one-time distributions to relationship-based engagement within an existing school structure. All planned activities were successfully delivered under budget.

2. Context & Rationale

This project represented a pivotal change in ADA's approach:

- **Previous model:** One-time distributions organized independently by ADA
- **New model:** Working within an existing school structure during regular hours
- **Strategic shift:** From event-based to relationship-based engagement

This was the first time ADA embedded its activities within a school's daily routine rather than organizing a standalone event.

3. Activities Delivered

3.1 School Visit

The ADA team of 6 volunteers arrived at the school during regular hours. Students were in Chemistry class when the team arrived. The school administration welcomed ADA and facilitated the engagement.

3.2 Mentorship Session

- Delivered encouragement and motivational talks to 25 students
- Provided life skills guidance and academic motivation
- Distributed educational materials and handouts
- Created an interactive and supportive environment

3.3 Feeding Program

- Provided food and refreshments to all 25 students
- Snacks and drinks served during the mentorship session
- School contributed additional refreshments (reducing costs)

3.4 Relationship Building

- Established ongoing partnership with school administration
- Agreed on framework for future visits
- School expressed interest in continued collaboration

4. Outcomes Achieved

Expected Outcome	Status
25 students engaged	✅ Achieved
Mentorship provided	✅ Achieved
Feeding program delivered	✅ Achieved
School relationship established	✅ Achieved
In-school engagement model piloted	✅ Achieved

5. Key Observations

- Students were receptive and engaged throughout the session
- Working within school hours ensured full attendance
- School staff were supportive and collaborative
- The in-school model is more sustainable than standalone events
- Blue-uniformed students (predominantly boys, ages 10–14) were the primary beneficiaries

6. Lessons Learned

1. **Institutional partnerships work** — Embedding within school structures provides access, credibility, and sustainability
2. **Cost efficiency** — Schools can contribute resources (refreshments), reducing project costs
3. **Attendance guaranteed** — Visiting during school hours ensures beneficiary participation
4. **Relationship over transaction** — Ongoing engagement creates deeper impact than one-time distributions

7. Recommendations

1. Replicate the in-school model at additional schools in Buea
2. Develop a structured mentorship curriculum for repeat visits
3. Schedule quarterly follow-up visits to maintain the relationship
4. Document the model as a template for future school-based interventions

8. Financial Summary

- **Budgeted:** 180,000 CFA ($300 USD)
- **Actual spend:** 165,000 CFA ($275 USD)
- **Savings:** 15,000 CFA ($25 USD) — school provided some refreshments
- **Budget utilization:** 91.7%

See full financial report: financial.md

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